Landed

THE

SUPERMARKET READY BLUEPRINT

What retail buyers actually check before they range a new Australian brand, from independents and IGA through to Coles and Woolworths. And whether you're ready.

A self-diagnostic tool for food and FMCG founders by Landed

25 Questions · 5 Sections · Instant Clarity

Is Your Brand Actually Ready?

You're building a food or FMCG brand in Australia. You've got a product you believe in. And you're trying to land it in retail, whether that's your local independents, IGA, or Coles and Woolworths, or you're already in and fighting to stay there.

Most founders and challenger brands walk into a buyer meeting thinking they're ready. They're not. Not because their product is bad, but because they haven't built the commercial foundation a professional buyer expects to see. Buyers can smell that in the first five minutes.

> Our team has spent years inside the commercial engine of leading FMCG businesses. The brands that get listed, and stay listed, all have the same things in place. This blueprint shows you exactly what those things are.

HOW TO USE THIS BLUEPRINT

STEP 01

Be Brutally Honest

Only check what is ACTUALLY in place right now. "Working on it" doesn't count. "Nearly done" doesn't count.

STEP 02

Find Your Gaps

The unchecked boxes are the things a buyer will find, or the things that get you delisted in year 1. Those are your priorities.

STEP 03

Know Where You Stand

Count your total at the end. The score tells you what to do next.

STEP 04

Act on It

A gap you know about is a gap you can fix. Most founders never get this level of clarity.

Your Product — Does It Actually Belong on Shelf?

Most founders think their product is ready. Buyers check things most founders have never thought about.

- ○ **My RSP is competitive with the category benchmark** — I've physically shopped the shelf and I know exactly where I sit on price vs. the rest of the set.
- ○ **I have a clear and defensible reason why a buyer should range me instead of an existing brand or private label** — and it's not just "better quality" or "it tastes amazing."
- ○ **I can demonstrate real-world sales velocity** — from DTC, farmers markets, independent retail, or foodservice, not just a forecast built on assumptions.
- ○ **I know what this retailer is actively looking for in my category right now** — my ranging rationale responds to their specific gap, not just my product story.
- ○ **My supply chain can handle the volume:** MOQs, lead times, and minimum fill rates are confirmed with my manufacturer before I make any commitments to a buyer.

Your Numbers — Can the Math Work for Everyone?

Buyers don't just range products they like. They range products where the commercial model stacks up. If your numbers don't work for them, the conversation ends there.

- ○ **I know my exact COGS, and my RSP delivers at least 35–45% retail margin after markdown allowance** — this is the minimum the major retailers expect from a new ranging.
- ○ **I've built a promotional budget into my P&L** — I understand that 15–25% of net revenue will be consumed by trade investment in year 1 alone.
- ○ **I know my break-even scan rate** — the number of units per store per week I need to sell to justify staying on shelf, and I have a plan to hit it.
- ○ **I can fund the first promotional cycle without destroying my cash position** — I've modelled what the first 3 months of deductions and promotional invoices look like.
- ○ **I've run my full P&L at promotional loading** — scan money, trade funding, and invoice deductions included, and I'm still making money at the bottom line.

Your Sell-In — Could You Win a Buyer Meeting This Week?

A good product with a weak sell-in loses to a weaker product with a sharp commercial story. Buyers see hundreds of brand pitches a year. You get one shot.

- ○ **I have a structured sell-in deck** — covering category opportunity, my ranging rationale, pricing architecture, distribution plan, and promotional plan for year 1.
- ○ **My pitch leads with category insights, not my brand story** — I can explain why the category needs my product, using data, not just passion.
- ○ **I know who I'm pitching to,** what their ranging priorities are right now, and what performance gap in their category I'm solving.
- ○ **I can articulate my point of difference in a single sentence** — clearly enough that a buyer could repeat it to their merchandise or business manager without me in the room.
- ○ **I've prepared for the negotiation, not just the pitch** — I know my fallback position and I've run a practice role-play of the three objections I'll hear most: "your velocity isn't there yet," "the margin doesn't work," and "we don't have space in the range."

Your Trade Terms — Do You Know What You're Signing Up To?

This is where brands die slowly. They get the listing, sign the terms, and six months later they're losing money on every case they sell — and they don't know why.

- ◯ **I know the total cost of trading with this retailer** — not just the headline shelf margin, but scan money, promotional funding, freight contributions, and co-op advertising combined.
- ◯ **I can model what my P&L looks like after 12 months of trading, including 3–4 promotional events and all associated deductions** — and I'm still making money.
- ◯ **I know which of their standard terms are negotiable** and I have a commercial position on each before I enter any discussion.
- ◯ **I've set a walk-away point** — the specific terms that would make this deal unprofitable, and I'm prepared to hold it.
- ◯ **I've had someone with deep FMCG experience review my commercial agreement** before I agreed to anything.

Your Year 1 Plan — Can You Survive the First Range Review?

Getting ranged is the beginning, not the destination. Most small brands get their first listing and then go quiet. Buyers notice. Range reviews are brutal without a plan.

- ○ **I have a velocity plan for the first 90 days post-ranging** — specific activities to drive trial and build scan rates before the retailer starts watching performance.
- ○ **I have a store execution plan** — someone is checking stores, managing voids, fixing shelf placement issues, and ensuring my product is actually on shelf.
- ○ **I know when my category's range review is scheduled,** what data the buyer will use to assess my performance, and what I need to achieve to defend my position.
- ○ **I've planned at least 2-3 promotional events in the first 6 months** — on-shelf activity that drives scan rates, not just price cuts that erode margin.
- ○ **I have a demand-generation plan outside the retailer** — social, DTC, PR, or foodservice that builds brand pull and makes my scan rates easier to hit.

Where Do You Stand?

Count how many boxes you checked across all 5 sections. Be honest; this is for you, not a buyer.

20–25

You're close. Start conversations.

You've done the work most founders skip. A few gaps to close, but you're in the right shape to approach a buyer. Use the Buyer Meeting Toolkit to sharpen your deck, validate your numbers, and walk in ready for anything.

10–19

You have real gaps. Fix them first.

Don't book a buyer meeting yet. The gaps you found are exactly what a professional buyer will find, and they'll use them to knock back your ranging or strip your terms. Close these gaps first, then go in.

Under 10

Stop. Build the foundation first.

Going in underprepared doesn't just lose you the listing; it burns the relationship with the buyer and makes it harder to come back. You now know exactly what needs to be built. Start there.

WHEN YOU'RE READY

Two ways we can help you go further

OPTION 01 · DO IT YOURSELF

The Buyer Meeting Toolkit — $47

Sell-In Deck Template (Canva)

10-slide pitch deck structured the way buyers want it. Guidance notes on every slide. Add your brand and go.

Commercial Model (Excel)

Retailer P&L, Supplier P&L, Trade Spend ROI, Annual Trading Calendar, Category View. Nothing like this exists publicly for Australian FMCG founders.

Objection Cheat Sheet (PDF)

10 objections buyers use to knock back new brands — and exactly how to handle each one. Walk in ready for anything they throw at you.

Get the Toolkit — $47

Option 02 · Founding Member Calls · over the page →

Founding Member Calls

$297 total

3 × 60-minute 1:1 sessions · $99 per call effective rate

If you spotted gaps in this blueprint and want direct help closing them before your next buyer meeting, this is for you. Three sessions with someone who has deep industry experience and can help fast-track your learning and preparation.

WHAT WE WORK THROUGH TOGETHER

Pitch Prep

We review your sell-in deck, sharpen your category story, and make sure your pitch lands. You walk in knowing exactly what to say and how to say it.

Numbers Review

We run your margin stack, model your trade spend, and stress-test your break-even. No surprises in the room when the buyer asks about your P&L.

Negotiation Strategy

We map out what's negotiable, set your walk-away point, and script your responses to the objections you'll face. Go in with a plan, not just a pitch.

Range Review Defence

Already listed and facing a review or delisting threat? We build your defence — velocity data, promotional plan, and the story that keeps you on shelf.

WHO THIS IS FOR

- You're serious about launching, or succeeding, with your dream of landing in retail, and you want to get it right.
- You want to fast-track your learning and skip the expensive mistakes most brands make on the way in.
- You want coaching from someone with deep industry experience to pressure-test your pitch and numbers, whether it's your first meeting or a range review.

Book Your Founding Member Calls — $297

Limited spots at this rate. Price increases once the full course launches. This is founding member pricing.